

The Essence of the Ten Perfections

Daśapāramitāhṛdaya · Toh 581 · Derge Kangyur

ཕ་རོལ་ཏུ་ཕྱུག་པ་བཅུ་སྟེང་པ་

Toh 581 in the Kangyur is a short dhāraṇī text known in Tibetan as "Pha rol tu phyin pa bcu'i snying po," which may be rendered in English as "The Essence of the Ten Perfections," with its Sanskrit title reconstructable as something close to Daśapāramitāhṛdaya. It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur, a class of texts preserving sacred mantra formulas and their associated spiritual benefits. The text concludes a preceding dhāraṇī said to bring about the taking up of the six perfections, then opens a brief teaching on the essence of the ten perfections, promising remarkable merit to anyone who hears it even once. As is characteristic of this genre, the content blends Sanskrit dhāraṇī syllables with short doctrinal framing, situating the power of the formula within the Mahāyāna framework of the perfections.

Mitājñāna gocārāya. Namō bhagavate. Jñānapāramitāyai. Jñānūṃ kuru kuru vigāna tathāgatasya. Samayam anusmara. Hī hī hī hī. Jñā jñā jñā jñā. Hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ.

Here ends the dhāraṇī that brings about the taking up of the six perfections.

The essence of the ten perfections: one who hears this even once will—

Translator's Notes

- The first paragraph is a Sanskrit dhāraṇī transcribed in Tibetan script and is rendered back into romanized Sanskrit rather than translated, as is standard practice for dhāraṇī formulas. The text then breaks off mid-sentence at the foot of a folio, with the passage ending abruptly at "will—" corresponding to the Tibetan གྲྀ་, which is the beginning of a word cut off by the page break. The full continuation is not present in the supplied passage.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.